



Tell Me Later

A small printed slip a student can fill in and post in a box when they want to talk to you but cannot say so out loud in front of the form. They write their name, tick how soon, and say as much or as little as they like about what it is about. Some students will never come and find you, and a slip and a box give them a way of asking that costs them nothing in front of everybody else.

Before you start. A slip can carry a disclosure, so treat this like any other route a student might use to tell you something. Empty the box every day without fail, pass anything that needs it to your designated safeguarding lead the same day through your school's own system, and be straight with the form from the start that you cannot promise to keep something to yourself if they or somebody else is not safe. Tell them what to do if it cannot wait until the box is next emptied.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The slips, six to a sheet. Print a couple of sheets to start with.
Page 3	The box label and the wall notice

How it works

Step	What happens
Before	Find a box. A shoebox with a slot in the lid is enough. Put it somewhere a student can reach without being watched, with the slips beside it.
1	Put the label on the box and the notice on the wall next to it, with the time you empty the box written in.
2	Tell the form how it works, including when you empty the box and what you have to pass on.
3	Empty the box at the same time every day, whether or not you are expecting anything to be in it.
4	Go and find the student the same day for anything ticked "today, please", and inside the week for the rest.

Worth knowing

- Say out loud that you empty the box every day, then do it. A box that might not be read is worse than no box, because a student who has used it believes they have asked.
- A slip with nothing on it but a name is still a student asking. Go and find them.
- Keep the slips where taking one is not an event in itself. If a student has to come and ask you for a slip, the point of it has gone.
- Works well alongside Conversation Starters, which gives you something to open the conversation with once they have asked.

Empty the box every day, and go and find whoever has used it.



The slips

Six to a sheet. Cut them apart and leave a stack of them somewhere a student can pick one up without anybody watching.

Tell me later

I would like to talk to you about something.

N A M E

F O R M

☐

This week is fine

☐

Today, please

You can say what it is about if you want to. You do not have to.

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The box label and the wall notice

Cut both out. The label goes on the box, the notice goes on the wall beside it, with the time you empty the box written in.

Tell me later

Put your slip in here.

How this works

If you want to talk to me but would rather not say so in front of everyone.

- 1.** Take a slip, fill it in and put it in the box.
- 2.** I empty the box every day at _____ and come to find you.
- 3.** If it cannot wait until then, tell me or any member of staff now.

I will keep it between us where I can. If you or somebody else is not safe, I have to pass it on, and I will tell you that I am doing it.